

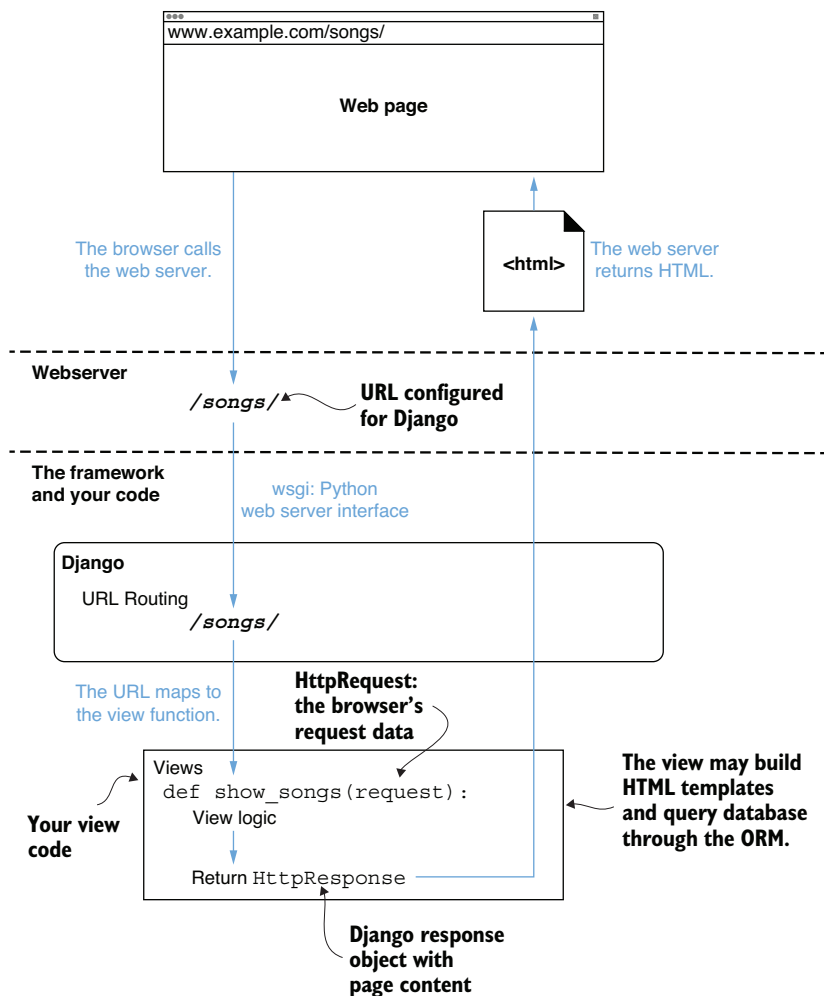


Figure 1.1 Django handling a page visit

particular pages. To facilitate communication with a database, Django includes an *object relational mapping* (ORM), the second of the three core parts. This is an abstraction that allows you to manage content in a database through Python classes and objects. If your web page requires information from the database, the ORM is used to look up a `QuerySet` object that contains database results. How to use the ORM as well as how it maps to a database are covered in chapter 4.

The third core part of Django is the templating engine, which helps you create and manage the HTML within your page response. HTML is a fairly verbose text format often containing a lot of repeated content. Using the templating engine, you define HTML templates that describe parts of a web page. The parts get assembled, composed, and reused to form the response to the user.